PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Mercedes-Benz G 63 AMG

2012–2018 (US 2013–2018) · W463 · M157 5.5 biturbo V8 · 7G-TRONIC

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Is it really a G 63?**
  Many G 550s have been fitted with AMG bumpers, grilles and badges. US G 63 VINs from Bring a Trailer listings begin WDCYC7DF (2013–2016) and WDCYC7DH (2018). A same-era G 550 reads WDCYC3HF. Check the VIN and data card, not the bodywork.
- [ ] **Recall paperwork**
  Make sure NHTSA 17V250 (steering coupling, 2013–2016) has been done. On 2016–17 trucks, also check 17V713 (ESP with DISTRONIC PLUS). Run the VIN through NHTSA's recall lookup before you hand over money.
- [ ] **Oil consumption and misfires**
  Ask how much oil it uses between services and scan for stored codes. The M157 can suffer cylinder scoring at higher mileage. Misfires are often plugs, coils or oil-soaked cam-magnet connectors, but persistent misfires or consumption justify a borescope before purchase.
- [ ] **Coolant around the turbos**
  Look for coolant crust or a sweet smell around the turbos and the lines that feed them, and check both coolant reservoirs. MBWorld owners report cracked turbo coolant lines, and a pressure test is cheap.
- [ ] **Oil at the cam magnets**
  Unplug a camshaft-adjuster magnet connector. If there's oil inside, it is wicking into the harness, and the magnets need replacing with sacrificial pigtails fitted.
- [ ] **Seals under the truck**
  Check for gear oil on the inside of the front wheels and on the big AMG calipers (front axle seals), at the transfer-case outputs and at the pinion seals. An MBWorld member says pinion seal leaks are 'very common around 60k–80k'.
- [ ] **Test all three lockers**
  Engage centre, rear and front in order on loose ground and watch the indicators. A truck that has only ever been driven on pavement can have lockers that don't engage.
- [ ] **Rust and drains**
  Check the tailgate's lower edge, door bottoms, sills, rear frame tubes and spring mounts. A G 63 rusts like any other G, and 20-inch wheels don't stop road salt.

YEARS TO KNOW

2016	RECALL	Recalls 17V178 (door cable) and 17V713 (ESP with DISTRONIC PLUS) cover 2016 trucks; 17V250 (steering coupling) covers 2013–2016

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Steering coupling may be under-tightened**
  2013–2016 · NHTSA 17V250
- [ ] **Inner door-release cable may break**
  2016 · NHTSA 17V178
- [ ] **ESP fault with DISTRONIC PLUS engaged**
  2016–2017 · NHTSA 17V713
- [ ] **eCall date/time software fault**
  2013–2017 · NHTSA 19V787
- [ ] **Communication-module software (eCall location)**
  2017–2018 · NHTSA 21V058

- [ ] **VIN characters 4–8**
  US G 63s sold on Bring a Trailer read WDCYC7DF… (2013–2016 examples) and WDCYC7DH… (2018). A 2011 G 55 reads WDCYC7BF… and a same-era G 550 WDCYC3HF….
- [ ] **Model year (10th character)**
  D = 2013, E = 2014, F = 2015, G = 2016, H = 2017, J = 2018.
- [ ] **Engine**
  A G 63 has the M157 5.5-litre biturbo V8: two turbochargers and AMG engine covers, and no supercharger on top. A G 550 has either the naturally aspirated M273 (to 2015) or the 4.0-litre M176.
- [ ] **Brakes and wheels**
  Factory G 63s have six-piston front calipers from the ML 63 on 14.8-inch discs, and 20-inch AMG wheels.
- [ ] **Power by year**
  2013–2015 trucks are 544 PS; 2016–2018 trucks, badged Mercedes-AMG G 63, are 571 PS (563 hp).

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/g-class/g63-amg/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks